

**SUPERIOR COURT OF SAN MATEO COUNTY****Probate - Probate****Courtroom 2C****Hearing Date: 09/10/2026 - 09:00 AM**

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Judge: Novak, Lisa A.**Clerk:** Ortega, Alexandrina**Reporter:** Conde, Wendy

22-PRO-01282	Conservatorship of MASON JAMES RICHTER	
Line 3	Proposed Conservatee: RICHTER, MASON JAMES Petitioner: RICHTER, EDWIN PATRCIK (DAYE, ROBERT E.) Petitioner: RICHTER, MARILYN KOROA (DAYE, ROBERT E.) Conservatee: RICHTER, MASON JAMES Proposed Conservator: RICHTER, EDWIN PATRICK (DAYE, ROBERT E.) Proposed Conservator: RICHTER, MARILYN KOROA (DAYE, ROBERT E.) Conservator: RICHTER, EDWIN PATRICK (DAYE, ROBERT E.) Conservator: RICHTER, MARILYN KOROA (DAYE, ROBERT E.)	Conservatorship Review - Biennial
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE The conservatorship shall continue and be reviewed in two (2) years; The assessment amount of \$850.00 for the cost of this investigation be ordered and deferred until the Court determines sufficient funds exist. Conservators are ordered to file of the Pre-Move Notice (GC-079) within 30 days, and the Post-Move Notice (GC-080) once the conservatee's move is completed.		

24-PRO-00825	Guardianship of Ethan A. Sfatcu	PETITION FOR: (1) AWARD OF GUARDIAN'S COMPENSATION; etc.
Line 4	Petitioner: Sfatcu, Vlad (ROWE, JESSICA L.) Ward: Sfatcu, Ethan A. (STEINER, KATRINA M.) Guardian: Sfatcu, Vlad Temporary Guardian: Sfatcu, Vlad Objector: ROSSFELD, KRYSTINA (Pro Se)	Status Hearing
Tentative Ruling: APPEARANCE OPTIONAL Matter CONTINUED to November 30, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. for notice to the ward under Probate Code § 1460(b)(2). The Court does not agree that paralegal Hutchinson's fee for work done from 6/23/2026 through 8/27/2026 justifies fees in the amount of \$30,429.00. It is difficult to approve this amount when taking into consideration the nature and difficulty of the tasks performed, results achieved, and benefit to the guardianship estate, as her hourly fee of \$300 greatly exceeds what a qualified accountant in the greater San Francisco Bay Area would have charged. While the Court agrees with counsel that greater expense would have been incurred had such services and tasks been performed by the attorneys, the guardian would have been more prudent with the estate's		



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finances if an accountant were hired to complete the accounting. As such, the fee award will be reduced, finding that \$200 per hour is a reasonable rate for Ms. Hutchinson's work on the accounting. [\$21,600 rather than \$30,429.00]. Once proper notice is provided to the ward, the court will then be prepared to approve the accounting and award fees as requested to the guardian, and the reduced fees to counsel consistent with this ruling. As such, petitioner shall submit a revised proposed order which reduces attorney fees by \$8,829.00

24-PRO-01251	IN RE THE ZAPLETAL FAMILY TRUST	
Line 5	Petitioner: Zapletal, Alexa (MANZOOR, SUMBLE NGUYEN, AILEEN R.) Respondent: Canas, Hernan (NOYES, GUY E. Pro Se) Respondent: Canas, Mary Ellen (Pro Se) Decedent: ZAPLETAL, DAWN Decedent: ZAPLETAL, RAYMOND Respondent: Shustoff, Mark A. (BIORN, KRISTOFER W.) Claimant: Phillips & Cohen Associates, Ltd.	Status Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

The Petition for Instruction set on October 20th will be re-set on October 30, 2026 when the First Amended Petition for Relief is set. The court accepts the stipulation of Petitioner and Respondent Trustee that Trustee's response to the initial petition, filed 4/4/2025, will act as his response to the First Amended Petition. The Court issues an Order to Show Cause as to why Mary Ellen Canas and Hernan Canas should not now be held in contempt for failing to abide by this court's previous order to pay monetary sanctions. That shall also be set on October 30, 2026 at 9:00 a.m.